

January 18, 1943

Conference with Consul General Wiley
re Jewish refugees. (1)

I conferred with Consul General Wiley today with respect to the telegram from the Treasury relating to the remittance of 2,000,000 francs by the J.D.C. for the initial expenses of the release of 1,500 refugees.)

He stated that it was not true that the refugees would be released upon the receipt of the "initial expenses" of their release; that a Joint Commission had been established to deal with the whole problem of the release of prisoners, including the Jewish refugees referred to, "Red" Spanish refugees, Polish refugees, Belgian refugees, Czech refugees, Russians, etc.; that this Commission was composed of the British Consul General, American Consul General, one representative of each, a psychological warfare representative and Dr. Strobe (loaned by Rockefeller Foundation to Red Cross); that the whole problem was a very difficult one and had to be carefully studied; that in general the prisoners would only be released after it was decided what should be done with the groups involved (as groups); that plans would have to be made for taking care of the refugees after they had been released before their release; that Elie Gozlan referred to in Treasury cable was a Frenchman (Jewish) heading up the organization referred to; that Gozlan had misunderstood the arrangements contemplated; that he did not believe that Gozlan was fully trustworthy; that Schwartz, European head of the J.D.C., had been requested to come to Algiers and was expected soon; that it would be better to deal with Schwartz rather than with Gozlan.)

When I asked Wiley how long he thought it would take before the refugees would be released he replied three or four months; that a considerable study of the problems involved would have to be made.)

I expressed to Mr. Wiley my failure to understand why it was taking so long to solve a problem which it seemed so important to solve as rapidly as possible; that he knew probably better than I the great amount of criticism which had been leveled at our position in this matter; that this type of criticism tended to hurt the war effort; and that it would seem to me that it would